

Teacher Guide — senior / module-04-doshas

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha

Band: Senior (Grades 9–12) · **Sessions:** 10 × 45 min · **Sanskrit:** Tri-doṣa

Overview

Three patterns of internal rhythm — *vāta* (motion), *pitta* (transformation), and *kapha* (structure) — that Āyurveda uses to describe individual constitutional differences. Mapped to *pañcabhūta* from Module 2 and framed as wellness lens, NOT medical diagnosis.

NEP 2020 alignment

- §4.6 — Integration of Indian Knowledge Systems
- §4.23 — Experiential learning (self-observation projects)
- §11.8 — Holistic, multidisciplinary education

Key terms (this module)

- *doṣa* — humour / functional principle
- *vāta* — motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)
- *pitta* — transformation principle (fire, tejas+ap)
- *kapha* — structure principle (cohesion, ap+pṛthvī)
- *prakṛti* — innate constitution
- *vikṛti* — current imbalance

Prerequisites

Module 2 (Panchabhūta) is recommended before this module. Modules 5 (Bindu Paddhati / dot addition) and 7 (×11 Multiplication) are useful prerequisites for Module 9 and 11.

Materials needed (across 10 days)

- Notebook + pencils per student
- Whiteboard / chart paper

- (See `lesson-plan.md` for per-day material lists)

10-day map

- **Day 1** — Three Doshas Introduction: Name vāta, pitta, kapha and recognise one observable trait of each.
- **Day 2** — Vāta — The Motion Principle: Identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.
- **Day 3** — Pitta — The Transformation Principle: Identify pitta-style behaviours (warm, sharp, focused, transforming).
- **Day 4** — Kapha — The Structure Principle: Identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).
- **Day 5** — Mapping to the Five Elements: Connect each doṣa to its two constituent elements (vāta=ākāśa+vāyu, pitta=tejas+ap, kapha=ap+pr̥thvī).
- **Day 6** — Prakṛti Self-Assessment: Use a worksheet to estimate own dominant doṣa(s) — emphasising NOT diagnosis.
- **Day 7** — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day: Map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.
- **Day 8** — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons: Map doṣa cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.
- **Day 9** — Balance and Imbalance: Distinguish prakṛti (innate) from vikṛti (current state); recognise simple imbalance signs.
- **Day 10** — Synthesis and Project Pitch: Pitch the 7-day self-observation project and answer assessment quiz.

Files in this pack

- `lesson-plan.md` — detailed 10-day arc
- `sources.md` — sources cited in this module
- `teacher-notes.md` — common misconceptions, differentiation
- `parent-guide.md` — what parents should know
- `days/day-NN-*.md` — 10 per-day lesson plans
- `quizzes/formative.md, quizzes/summative.md`
- `activities/activity-01-*.md`
- `assessments/rubric.md, assessments/project-brief.md`
- `student-workbook.md`
- `writing-prompts.md` (or `oral-recall.md` for Primary)
- `homework.md`
- `slides/deck.md`

Voice

Analytical, comparative, primary-source aware; 20–30 words on average. Pitches the concept first, frames the tradition as historical context, and uses IAST for all Sanskrit terms.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

10-day arc, 45 min per session.

Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction

Objective: Name vāta, pitta, kapha and recognise one observable trait of each.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

Objective: Identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle

Objective: Identify pitta-style behaviours (warm, sharp, focused, transforming).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

Objective: Identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

Objective: Connect each doṣa to its two constituent elements (vāta=ākāśa+vāyu, pitta=tejas+ap, kapha=ap+prthvī).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment

Objective: Use a worksheet to estimate own dominant doṣa(s) — emphasising NOT diagnosis.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

Objective: Map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

Objective: Map doṣa cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance

Objective: Distinguish prakṛti (innate) from vikṛti (current state); recognise simple imbalance signs.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch

Objective: Pitch the 7-day self-observation project and answer assessment quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Senior sessions are 45 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

Common student misconceptions

- *“This is religious, not scientific.”* — Frame the tradition as historical observation. Pañcabhūta-like classifications of matter exist in many cultures. Indian astronomy and math are documented, peer-reviewed historical fields.
- *“The Sanskrit terms are just jargon.”* — Insist on the triple format (Sanskrit / IAST / meaning) once, then use the Sanskrit alone. The terms are precise; the discipline of using them properly is itself a learning outcome.
- *“If it’s traditional, it must work.”* — Distinguish empirical claims (testable) from ethical/aesthetic frames (which need separate justification). Encourage students to ask “how would I test this?”.

Differentiation strategies

- **Extension for advanced students:** offer one optional “deeper read” per day — usually a primary source or modern paper.

- **Support for students needing scaffolds:** more pair-work, allow oral responses, provide partial outlines for writing prompts.
- **Multilingual classrooms:** Sanskrit terms are universal; vernacular equivalents (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi etc.) should be welcomed.

Safety

- Any activity involving food, plants, fire, or outdoor work needs explicit safety briefing.
- See the relevant day file for activity-specific safety notes.

Honest framing

- Where modern science clearly extends or revises traditional claims, say so.
- Where the tradition's framing is best understood as ethical/aesthetic, present it as such (not as competing science).
- Where attribution is debated (e.g., the “Vedic” status of Tirthaji's mathematics), present the debate honestly.

End-of-module reflection (for teachers)

- Which concepts landed well? Which didn't?
- Which students grew most? Which need a different approach next module?
- Add notes to `teacher-notes.md` for the next teacher who uses this pack.

Sources

Sources — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

Primary and secondary sources

- Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.57–58 (definition of three doṣas)
- Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.7 (doṣa-dhātu-mala framework)
- Robert Svoboda, *Prakriti: Your Ayurvedic Constitution* (1998) — modern intro
- NCERT Biology Class XII, Chapter on human physiology (compare physiological rhythms)

A note on citation discipline

Per the curriculum's style guide, citations must be verifiable. If a verse number, page, or attribution cannot be confirmed, the source is paraphrased without invented attribution. Where direct quotes appear in Senior-band day files, the source is identified in IAST + edition.

For deeper reading

- The shared glossary at `curriculum/_shared/glossary.md` contains the IAST + meaning for every Sanskrit term used.

- Other modules in this curriculum that connect: see the module README’s “Prerequisites” section.

Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: name vāta, pitta, kapha and recognise one observable trait of each.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *doṣa* (IAST: doṣa; lit. “humour / functional principle”)

Primary source (today’s reading)

From *Caraka Saṁhitā* — see `sources.md`.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Open with observation.** Project on the board: “*Describe three students you know — without naming them — in one sentence each, focusing on their energy, pace, and style.*” Pair discussion for 2 minutes; harvest descriptions on the board.
2. **From observation to category.** Most descriptions cluster around three patterns: quick / changeable / dry (motion); focused / sharp / warm (transformation); steady / slow / cool (structure). Classical Āyurveda calls these three patterns *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha* — the three *doṣas*.
3. **Define each precisely.** Map to Module 2 elements:
 - *vāta* — wind-like, motion; from *ākāśa* + *vāyu*
 - *pitta* — fire-like, transformation; from *tejas* + *ap*
 - *kapha* — earth-like, structure; from *ap* + *pṛthvī*

4. **Source check.** Read aloud: > *vāyuh pittaṁ kaphaścoktaḥ śārīro doṣa-saṅgrahaḥ* > “Wind, bile, phlegm — the summary of the bodily doṣas.” > — Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.57
5. **Critical clarification, repeated:** Doṣas are NOT diseases. They are patterns of internal rhythm. Every person has all three — the ratio differs. This is a *wellness lens*, NOT *diagnosis*. Refer any health concern to a doctor.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Three Doshas Introduction.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *vāta* (IAST: *vāta*; lit. “motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Observe motion.** Watch a leaf in a draft, a flag on a breezy day, or a fan spinning. “*What do you notice about the air’s qualities? Is it predictable or changeable?*”
2. **Define *vāta*.** Motion principle. Five subtypes are described in Caraka:
 - *prāṇa* — inhalation, heart, head
 - *udāna* — speech, exhalation
 - *samāna* — digestion, equilibrium
 - *apāna* — elimination, downward flow
 - *vyāna* — circulation, full-body movement
3. **Vāta qualities (*guṇas*):** dry, light, cold, rough, subtle, mobile, clear. Have students list one observation matching each quality.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 12 enumerates *vāta-prakopa* (vāta aggravation) signs: dry skin, restless sleep, anxiety, irregular digestion. Read one paragraph.
5. **Modern bridge.** *Vāta* maps loosely to *autonomic nervous-system arousal patterns* and *peristaltic / circulatory rhythms*. Be careful: this is a wellness lens — NOT diagnosis.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Vāta — The Motion Principle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify pitta-style behaviours (warm, sharp, focused, transforming).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *pitta* (IAST: pitta; lit. “transformation principle (fire, tejas+ap)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Observe transformation.** Light a candle (or use a torch). “*The candle’s flame transforms wax to gas to light and heat. The stomach transforms food to energy. The eye transforms light into perception.*” Pitta = transformation.
2. **Define *pitta*.** Five subtypes:
 - *pācaka* — digestive fire
 - *rañjaka* — blood and complexion
 - *sādhaka* — intellect, emotional fire
 - *ālocaka* — vision
 - *bhrājaka* — skin lustre
3. **Pitta qualities (*guṇas*):** hot, sharp, light, oily, slightly oily, spreading, liquid. Compare with *vāta*.

4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 12 on *pitta-prakopa*: irritability, inflammation, acid reflux, hot flashes, intense focus.
5. **Modern bridge.** *Pitta* maps loosely to *metabolic rate, thermoregulation, inflammatory response*. Wellness lens, not diagnosis. Class discussion: “Why might a ‘pitta person’ suit a cool, calm work environment?”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Pitta — The Transformation Principle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “What’s one thing you learned today?”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *kapha* (IAST: *kapha*; lit. “structure principle (cohesion, *ap+prthvī*)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Observe structure.** Hold up a rock or thick block. “*This stays in shape. It is solid, cool, heavy. It holds its form.*” Kapha = the structure principle.
2. **Define *kapha*.** Five subtypes:
 - *avalambaka* — lubrication of joints, chest
 - *kledaka* — stomach moisture
 - *bodhaka* — saliva, taste
 - *tarpaka* — brain cushioning
 - *śleṣaka* — joint cohesion
3. **Kapha qualities (*guṇas*):** heavy, slow, cool, oily, smooth, soft, dense, stable, gross. Compare with vāta + pitta.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 12 on *kapha-prakopa*: heaviness, sluggishness, congestion, weight gain, emotional attachment.
5. **Modern bridge.** *Kapha* maps loosely to *anabolic / structural metabolism, connective-tissue density, parasympathetic dominance*. Wellness lens, not diagnosis. “*Why might a ‘kapha person’ thrive in a stable, predictable routine?*”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Kapha — The Structure Principle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: connect each *doṣa* to its two constituent elements (*vāta*=*ākāśa*+*vāyu*, *pitta*=*tejas*+*ap*, *kapha*=*ap*+*prthvī*).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See *lesson-plan.md* for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *prakṛti* (IAST: *prakṛti*; lit. “innate constitution”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Recall Module 2 *pañcabhūta*:** *ākāśa* (space), *vāyu* (air), *tejas* (fire), *ap* (water), *prthvī* (earth).
2. **Map *doṣas* to element pairs.** Caraka’s framework:
 - *vāta* = *ākāśa* + *vāyu* (both light, mobile)
 - *pitta* = *tejas* + *ap* (transformation + medium)
 - *kapha* = *ap* + *prthvī* (cohesion + heaviness)
3. **Why pairs, not single elements?** Each *doṣa* needs a quality AND a medium. *Vāyu* alone has no container; *tejas* alone burns without medium; *prthvī* alone is inert. The pair makes the *doṣa* functional.
4. **Source.** Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.7 — the *tridoṣa* are the gross outcome of the *pañcamahābhūta*.

5. **Class exercise.** Pairs receive a list of 10 observations (“warm forehead,” “dry skin,” “feels heavy after lunch”). Classify each by likely doṣa AND the element pair that grounds the claim.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Mapping to the Five Elements.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: use a worksheet to estimate own dominant doṣa(s) — emphasising not diagnosis.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *vikṛti* (IAST: vikṛti; lit. “current imbalance”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Distinguish prakṛti from vikṛti.** *Prakṛti* = innate constitution (birth ratio of doṣas, stable through life). *Vikṛti* = current state (today’s ratio, fluctuates). This distinction is *critical* — it stops students treating self-assessment as labelling.
2. **Self-assessment worksheet.** Distribute a 30-question checklist (sleep, digestion, body frame, temperament, energy patterns). Students mark each on a 1–5 scale for “*how true is this for me usually.*”
3. **Score and discuss.** Tally for each doṣa. *Most students will be mixed.* That’s the expected result. Mono-doṣic types are rare; *dvi-doṣa* (dual) is common.
4. **The rule of the day, said three times:** This is a self-observation exercise. NOT a diagnosis. NOT a prediction. Refer any health concern to a doctor.
5. **Caraka cite.** Caraka Saṁhitā, *Vimāna* 8.95–117 outlines the constitutional assessment method — historical context, NOT a clinical tool for school use.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Prakṛti Self-Assessment.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *doṣa* (IAST: doṣa; lit. “humour / functional principle”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Project the doṣa clock.** On the board, draw a 24-hour ring divided into three two-period segments:
 - **Kapha hours:** 6–10 am and 6–10 pm — heavy, slow start; calm wind-down.
 - **Pitta hours:** 10 am–2 pm and 10 pm–2 am — sharp focus; metabolic peak.
 - **Vāta hours:** 2–6 am and 2–6 pm — light, mobile, creative.
2. **Source.** Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.8 on *kāla-prabhāva* (time-of-day influence on doṣa).
3. **Match observations to hours.** “*When is your sharpest study time? When do you feel heaviest? When are dreams most active?*” Pair this to the chart. Most students will recognise the pitta-noon peak and the kapha-morning slump.
4. **Modern bridge.** Map onto circadian-rhythm research: cortisol peaks ~8 am (kapha-clearance), core body temperature peaks ~mid-afternoon (pitta), REM sleep dominates ~3–5 am (vāta).
5. **Independent work.** Each student sketches their own 24-hour clock and annotates which hours they feel each doṣa dominate. Compare in pairs.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Doṣa Rhythms in a Day.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: map doṣa cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *vāta* (IAST: vāta; lit. “motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The annual doṣa cycle.** Three seasonal phases dominate (varies by region):
 - **Vasanta (spring) — kapha season:** snowmelt, congestion, allergies; kapha accumulates over winter and is released now.
 - **Grīṣma + Varṣā (summer / monsoon) — pitta season:** heat, inflammation, digestive fire dips.
 - **Śarad + Hemanta + Śīśira (autumn / winter) — vāta season:** dryness, cold, wind; circulatory and joint stiffness.
2. **Source.** Caraka Saṃhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 6 — *ṛtucaryā* (seasonal regimen).
3. **Map to your region.** Indian classical descriptions correspond to North Indian climates. “How do these doṣa-seasons map to YOUR local climate?” Coastal, hill, and desert students will adapt differently.
4. **Modern bridge.** Hay-fever in spring (immune activation matching kapha-release), heat-stroke risk in summer (pitta), dry-skin and joint pain in winter (vāta) — all empirically documented in Indian medical literature.
5. **Discussion.** “What seasonal adjustment would you make to your routine — sleep, food, exercise — based on today’s doṣa-season?” Each student writes one specific adjustment.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “What’s one thing you learned today?”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish prakṛti (innate) from vikṛti (current state); recognise simple imbalance signs.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *pitta* (IAST: pitta; lit. “transformation principle (fire, tejas+ap)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the distinction.** Balance (*sāmya*) = each doṣa at its individual baseline. Imbalance (*vaiṣāmya*) = a doṣa deviates from baseline. *Vikṛti* is the language for the deviated state.
2. **Recognise simple imbalance signs.** From Caraka, *Sūtrasthāna* 18:
 - Vāta excess — dryness, irregularity, anxiety, joint cracking
 - Pitta excess — heat, inflammation, irritability, acid reflux
 - Kapha excess — congestion, lethargy, attachment, fluid retention
3. **The five-stage progression (*samprāpti*).** Doṣa imbalance progresses: accumulation → aggravation → spread → localisation → manifestation → chronicity. The earlier you notice, the easier to redirect. This is the framework’s preventive logic.
4. **Critical limits.** What this module *does not* claim: that you can self-diagnose serious illness, that you should self-medicate, or that doṣa balance replaces medical care. Repeat: WELLNESS LENS, NOT DIAGNOSIS.
5. **Reflection.** “*Identify one mild imbalance you experienced this week. Which doṣa? What likely drove it (diet, sleep, weather, stress)? What single adjustment might help?*”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Balance and Imbalance.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: pitch the 7-day self-observation project and answer assessment quiz.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *kapha* (IAST: *kapha*; lit. “structure principle (cohesion, *ap+pr̥thvī*)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Recap the framework in 3 sentences.** Students take turns: someone explains *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*; the next student explains the element-mapping; the third explains *prakṛti* vs *vikṛti*. Catch errors collaboratively.
2. **Project pitch.** Hand out the project brief — 7-day doṣa self-observation. Students read silently for 5 minutes.
3. **Pair brainstorm.** In pairs: “*What three things will you track each day? Why those?*” (Common picks: sleep, food, energy, mood, digestion, social interactions.)
4. **Source-anchoring.** For Senior credit, every project must cite at least one Caraka or Aṣṭāṅga reference. Browse the *Sūtrasthāna* index in *sources.md* together.
5. **Critical-thinking close.** “*What are the limits of this self-observation? What might it tell you? What might it MISS?*” Students draft one paragraph on these limits as part of their project journal Day 1.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Synthesis and Project Pitch.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Formative Quiz — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

When: mid-module (after Day 5). **Duration:** 25 minutes. **Format:** mix of short answer, multiple choice, and reflection.

Questions

1. Name the three / four key terms introduced in this module so far. Give the IAST and one-line meaning of each.
2. State the central idea of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha in one sentence.
3. (Multiple choice) Which day in this module focused on ‘Pitta — The Transformation Principle’? (a) Day 1 (b) Day 2 (c) Day 3 (d) Day 4
4. True / False — and explain in one sentence: *Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha is purely a religious concept and has no scientific framing.*
5. Connect Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha to **one** other module in this curriculum. Which module, and how?
6. List **two** sources cited so far in this module.
7. (Short answer) Why does the module distinguish ‘doṣa’ from related concepts? Give one example.
8. (Short answer) In your own words, explain Day 3’s concept.
9. Identify **one** common misconception about Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha and rebut it in one sentence.
10. Write **one** question you have about this module so far — something you want clarified before the summative.

How this is used

This quiz is **formative** — it’s a check-in to see what’s landing, not a grade. Teacher reviews answers to adjust pacing for Days 6–10. Students may swap and self-mark.

Summative Quiz — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

When: end of module (after Day 10). **Duration:** 45 minutes. **Total points:** 30.

Questions

Part A — Vocabulary (~5 points) A1. Define *doṣa* in your own words. A2. Define *vāta* in your own words. A3. Define *pitta* in your own words. A4. Define *kapha* in your own words. A5. Define *prakṛti* in your own words.

Part B — Concepts (~10 points) B1. Explain the central idea of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha in your own words (3–4 sentences). B2. Describe the method or framework students used in Day 4 of this module. B3. Identify ONE source cited in this module and explain why it matters. B4. Compare Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha with a concept from another module (your choice). What’s similar, what’s different? B5. Identify ONE common misconception about this module and rebut it in 2–3 sentences.

Part C — Application (~5 points) C1. Give an example of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha from your own daily life. C2. Describe one way this module connects to a current real-world issue (or scientific question).

Part D — Reflection (~5 points; ungraded for content) D1. What surprised you most in this module? D2. What's one question you still have?

Part E — Primary source (~5 points; Senior only) E1. Quote or paraphrase one passage from a primary source cited in this module. Explain it in your own words.

Marking guidance

- Vocabulary: give credit for correct meaning, even if exact wording differs.
- Concepts: look for evidence of understanding, not memorisation.
- Application: any reasonable example accepted.
- Reflection: ungraded for content; awarded for thoughtfulness.

Pass mark

A score of 18/30 indicates the student has met the module's learning objectives.

Homework

Homework — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.

- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

Use these for in-class writing, homework, or assessment. Each prompt is suitable for a 300-word response.

1. In 3–4 sentences, explain Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha to a friend who hasn't taken this module.
2. Choose one Sanskrit term from this module. Define it, then describe one observation from your own life that matches.
3. Compare Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha with a similar concept from another module or from your science textbook. What's similar? Different?
4. Identify ONE claim in this module that you'd want to test. How would you test it?
5. What was the most surprising thing in this module? Why did it surprise you?
6. Pick one source cited in this module. Write 2 sentences explaining why it matters.
7. What is one common misconception about Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha? Rebut it in 2–3 sentences.
8. Imagine you are teaching this module to a younger student. What would you say first?
9. Read one primary-source passage cited in this module. Translate or paraphrase it; comment on what it adds to your understanding.
10. Identify a contemporary debate about the IKS framework presented here (e.g., is Tirthaji's mathematics genuinely Vedic? are doṣas a valid framework today?). Take a position with two pieces of evidence.

How to use

- Pick **one** prompt per day for the writing-prompts homework.
- Or assign all of them across the module, alternating between in-class and home.
- Senior students may treat any prompt as a 500-word essay topic.

Activity 1 — Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

circular paper plate, coloured markers, ruler

What students do

Students mark a 24-hour clock face into three doṣa segments — kapha (6–10 am and 6–10 pm), pitta (10 am–2 pm and 10 pm–2 am), vāta (2–6 am and 2–6 pm). They note one personal activity that fits each segment and share with a partner.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.
- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Seven-Day Doṣa Self-Observation

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior

What you will do

Chart your daily routine — sleep, food, energy, mood — for 7 days through the doṣa lens. Write a one-page reflection. **THIS IS NOT DIAGNOSIS.** Refer any health concern to a doctor.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a poster / model / digital deliverable).
- **Written reflection** (500 words (Senior)): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (5-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 3 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.

Rubric

Assessment Rubric — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

This rubric applies to the project (see `project-brief.md`) and may also inform the summative quiz.

Criteria

Accuracy of concepts — uses Sanskrit terms correctly, gets the central idea right

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Source discipline — cites sources, distinguishes traditional framing from empirical claim

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Application — connects the module to other modules and to real-world examples

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Presentation — clear, organised, evidence-supported

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Reflection — honest, thoughtful, identifies what was learned and what remains uncertain

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

How the teacher uses this rubric

1. After the project share, score each student on each criterion.
2. Convert to a band (4 = Exceeding, 3 = Meeting, etc.) for the report card.
3. Share at least one strength and one area for growth with each student.

Self-assessment (Senior students)

Senior students complete a parallel self-assessment using the same rubric before the teacher's assessment. The teacher and student then meet to compare.